STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

The Boekenhouthoek Agri-Tech & Skills Hub

A 2-hectare climate-smart farming and youth-skills initiative designed to pair profitable horticulture with digital innovation, local recruitment, and data-driven farm management in KwaNdebele.

PREPARED FOR
Lima Rural Development Foundation

LOCATION
Boekenhouthoek, Zithabiseni, KwaNdebele (Thembisile Hani Local Municipality, Mpumalanga)

PROJECT SIZE
2 Hectares

IMPLEMENTING PARTNERS
Boekenhouthoek Farm & BKKINNOVATIONHUB

FOCUS
Climate-Smart Horticulture, Agri-Tech, & Youth Employment

> This proposal presents a practical rural development model where intensive farming, youth recruitment, digital tools, and skills training operate together as one scalable local enterprise.

1 Executive Summary

The Boekenhouthoek Agri-Tech & Skills Hub is a proposed 2-hectare intensive farming enterprise in Zithabiseni, KwaNdebele. The initiative is structured as a strategic joint venture between local agricultural management and BKKINNOVATIONHUB, with the shared objective of building a profitable, climate-resilient agricultural business that responds directly to local food insecurity and youth unemployment.

Beyond production, the project is designed to function as a localized, tech-enabled training ground. We are seeking a strategic partnership with the Lima Rural Development Foundation to support the agricultural infrastructure rollout, while BKKINNOVATIONHUB contributes its youth recruitment network, digital systems expertise, and operating support for data-driven farm management.

2 The Local Context & The Innovation Gap

The communities surrounding Zithabiseni face two linked pressures: persistently high youth unemployment and growing vulnerability to climate-induced food insecurity. Agriculture remains one of the clearest pathways to local economic activity, yet many young people remain disconnected from conventional farming models that feel informal, low-tech, and limited in future opportunity.

At the same time, small-scale farming across the Nkangala district often struggles with weak record keeping, inconsistent production planning, and limited access to modern management tools. This project addresses that gap by combining intensive, high-yield agriculture with digital innovation, structured youth recruitment, and practical agribusiness training.

3 The Agricultural Model: Intensive & Climate-Smart

To maximize the profitability and resilience of the 2-hectare footprint, the farm will be operated on high-yield, short-turnaround principles that prioritize output, water efficiency, and year-round production stability.

Intensive Horticulture (1.5 Hectares)

Cultivation of high-demand cash crops such as cabbages, tomatoes, and spinach, using crop rotation to protect soil health, reduce pest pressure, and sustain productivity over time.

Precision Irrigation

Borehole-linked drip irrigation systems will conserve water, improve yield per drop, and support dependable production even during hotter, drier periods.

Poultry Integration (0.5 Hectares)

A short-cycle broiler and layer unit will generate recurring cash flow to help cover operating costs while also supplying organic manure to reduce dependency on synthetic fertilizers.

Commercial Logic

The model is structured to balance quick-turn income streams with crop-based value creation, strengthening the site's path to operational sustainability.

4 The BKKINNOVATIONHUB Advantage

What makes this proposal especially scalable is the integration of BKKINNOVATIONHUB as the primary operating affiliate. The Hub brings the digital and human-capital infrastructure needed to turn a productive farm into a modern community development platform.

- **The Youth Database & Recruitment:** BKKINNOVATIONHUB manages a large centralized database of local youth, enabling rapid identification, recruitment, and onboarding of young people seeking employment and practical skills exposure.
- **Agri-Tech & Custom UI/UX Platform:** Leveraging the Hub's capabilities in coding, software development, and UI/UX design, BKKINNOVATIONHUB will develop a user-friendly digital dashboard to track crop cycles, manage workforce data, monitor water usage, and organize local off-take relationships.
- **Digital Literacy Integration:** Youth participating in the project will gain exposure not only to modern farming methods, but also to digital literacy, data capture, and technology use in agribusiness, improving long-term employability far beyond the farm gate.

5 Alignment with Lima's Core Objectives

Socio-Economic Impact

The project creates direct jobs and training opportunities, with local recruitment made more precise and inclusive through BKKINNOVATIONHUB's demographic data and youth outreach channels.

Modernizing Agriculture

The model shifts rural farming away from informal subsistence patterns and toward formalized, tech-enabled micro-commercial enterprise management.

Food Security

Fresh, affordable, climate-resilient produce will be supplied into nearby markets including Kwaggafontein and Zithabiseni, supporting local food access and circulation of value within the area.

Shared Development Logic

Lima's agricultural expertise and BKKINNOVATIONHUB's digital operating capability are highly complementary, making this a strong partnership model for measurable rural impact.

6 The Request for Support

To launch the Boekenhouthoek Agri-Tech & Skills Hub successfully, we are requesting Lima's support in the physical agricultural rollout while BKKINNOVATIONHUB leads the digital systems, recruitment pipeline, and youth skills integration.

- **Infrastructure:** Support with securing the water source, including borehole and drip irrigation systems, as well as land preparation through fencing and clearing.
- **Input Linkages:** Access to climate-resilient seed varieties, quality seedlings, and organic fertilizer inputs appropriate for intensive horticulture production.
- **Extension Mentorship:** Technical agricultural mentorship from Lima's agronomists, paired with BKKINNOVATIONHUB's digital tracking and reporting systems to improve accountability and performance management.

7 Projected Outcomes & Sustainability

Within 18 months, the site is expected to achieve financial independence through diversified crop and poultry sales. During the same period, BKKINNOVATIONHUB will onboard, train, and digitally upskill a rotating cohort of local youth, demonstrating that technology and agriculture can function together as dual engines of rural development in KwaNdebele.

This proposal offers more than a farming project. It offers a replicable community model in which land, data, youth opportunity, and climate-smart production are aligned into one practical platform for local growth.